

Cary Jones

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July 24, 2026

Engineering Team

Whatnot

Los Angeles, CA

Re: Senior Software Engineer

Dear Whatnot Hiring Team,

I am writing to express my strong interest in the Senior Software Engineer role at Whatnot. The opportunity to help build live commerce at a scale that has never been done in the West — with no playbook to copy — is exactly the kind of high-impact, ambiguous engineering challenge where I do my best work. Based in Temple City, I am within commuting distance of your **Los Angeles hub** and excited about Whatnot's blend of remote flexibility and in-person collaboration.

My background aligns closely with what you're building:

- **Scalable Python backend systems:** I have 15+ years designing and operating production distributed services in **Python** — microservices, event-driven architectures, and high-concurrency APIs — with a track record of balancing speed, reliability, and long-term maintainability.
- **Marketplace & product impact:** At KeyIngredient, I built core **e-commerce backend APIs** for a consumer marketplace and led Scrum delivery that drove measurable business outcomes. I prioritize customer and business impact and can articulate why the work matters — not just how it's built.
- **Ownership at scale:** At Disney and across consulting engagements, I have owned complex systems processing millions of daily events and **\$10M+ in daily transaction metrics**, with **99.99% uptime** and rigorous operational discipline.
- **Technical leadership:** I lead through code reviews, design discussions, mentorship, and cross-functional partnership with Product and engineering teams — raising the bar while helping teams move quickly.

What draws me to Whatnot is the combination of rapid growth, real product ambiguity, and the chance to shape how an entirely new industry develops. I am comfortable figuring things out as I go, biased toward action, and genuinely curious about the systems and people behind the product. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to Buyer Growth, Core Infrastructure, or whichever pillar needs strong backend engineering most.

As an honorably discharged U.S. Marine Corps veteran, I bring disciplined ownership and a bias toward outcomes over credit. Thank you for your time — I would love to discuss how my experience can support Whatnot's mission.

Sincerely,

Cary Jones

Senior Software Engineer